

Introduction to Outlier

Contributor (CB) Guidelines

Welcome to Outlier!

In this exercise, you'll get hands-on experience with the Outlier tasking environment while practicing skills that mirror real-world project scenarios. You'll write a thoughtful prompt, design a rubric to measure response quality, evaluate model outputs against your criteria, and make a final judgment on the best response. This practice will help you build confidence in creating high-quality data using rubrics, preparing you for more advanced tasks ahead.

Project Rules

While this is a PRACTICE project, future tasks will ask you to avoid the following:

- ❌ ChatGPT or other AI tools are NOT PERMITTED to write prompts, evaluate responses, or write justifications.
- ❌ Using AI tools will result in a flag on your account for removal from the project and can lead to removal from the platform.

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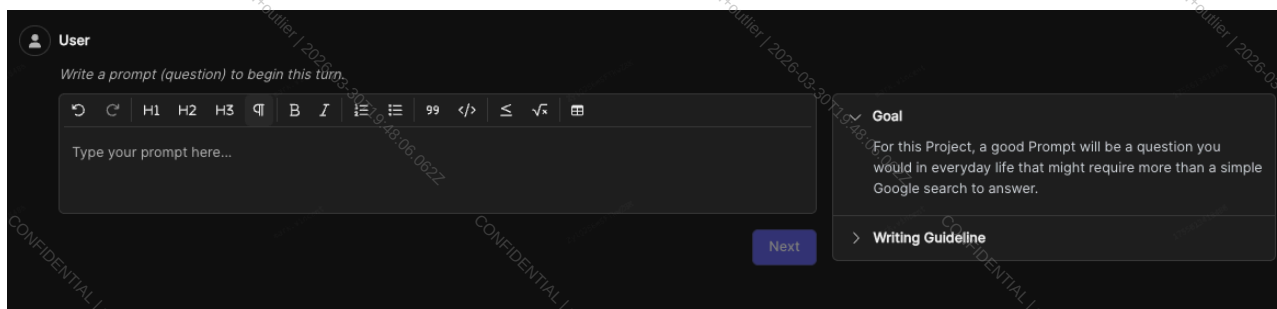
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Step-by-Step Task Workflow

Step 1: Write A Prompt

Create a prompt that has a natural way of asking and (if you choose to continue the conversation) flows with the previous turns.

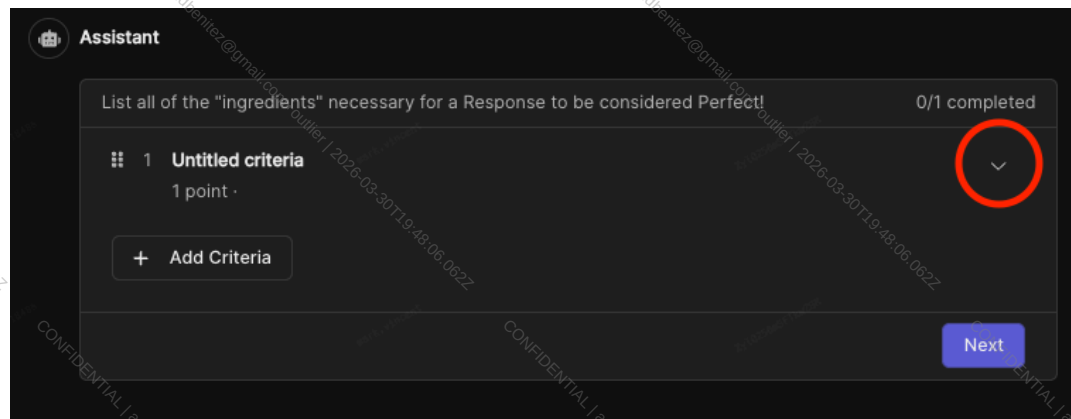


The screenshot shows a chat interface with a dark theme. On the left, a user icon is labeled 'User'. Below it, the text 'Write a prompt (question) to begin this turn.' is displayed. A text input field contains the placeholder 'Type your prompt here...'. Above the input field is a rich text editor toolbar with icons for undo, redo, bold, italic, link, unlink, bulleted list, numbered list, indent, outdent, code, link, unlink, and image. To the right of the input field is a blue 'Next' button. Further right, a 'Goal' section contains the text: 'For this Project, a good Prompt will be a question you would in everyday life that might require more than a simple Google search to answer.' Below the goal is a 'Writing Guideline' section with a right-pointing arrow.

- 1a** Good prompts will follow these general guidelines, these may differ slightly from project to project.
- a. Sounds natural (no life stories, no stacked questions, no artificial constraints).
 - b. Avoids genericness ("Explain water", "Describe air" are generic)
 - c. Maintains coherence (related follow-up prompts exist)
- 1b** When writing a prompt make sure to **avoid** the following:
- a. **Is Purely Subjective or Unverifiable Assessments:** Where no answer is better or worse than another outside of a personal preference ("What is the best color to paint this room?")
 - b. **Contains Frequently Changing Information:** Prompt question would be answered differently based on the last time the model was updated. (e.g. "What is the best-performing team in the NFL?")
 - c. **Is Engineered to Fail a Model:** Prompt does not reflect real things a person would ask and instead just tries to trick the model with contrived asks and constraints (e.g. "Tell me all the Nobel Prize categories related to science, but skip the ones that start with "P", and return them in reverse alphabetical order"). Neither of the constraints (start with "P" and reverse alphabetical order) would serve any purpose to a real user and are just here to cause a failure.
 - d. **Includes a ton of background and unnecessary details:** If it is mentioned in the prompt it should be something that is needed to answer/narrow down the request.
 - e. **A nearly identical repeat of a previous turn's prompt.**
 - f. **A prompt that was addressed in a previous turn's response.**

Step 2: Create A Rubric

It is helpful to think of a rubric like a recipe; however, instead of ingredients, a rubric lists out criteria. If you follow the steps of the recipe (i.e. criteria) you should end up with an ideal response.



Assistant

List all of the "ingredients" necessary for a Response to be considered Perfect! 0/1 completed

1 Untitled criteria
1 point

+ Add Criteria

Next

Also consider how you would **capture the qualities of the best responses** and **screen out the errors of the worst responses**. Don't be afraid to write criteria for things that should not be included in the response based on errors found in the responses.

2a Write out each criterion, ensuring that each meets the following requirements:

Appropriately atomic	Specific	Self Contained	Accurate	Is not a repeat of a previous criterion
related to a single challenge in the prompt and avoids stacking multiple expectations into one criterion	containing sufficient textual detail	can be evaluated without any knowledge or information other than what is contained in that criteria	correct by fact check / reason	Is not a repeat of a previous criterion

2b Provide **key details** for the Criterion you have written:

Step 2: Create A Rubric

1

The response must indicate 9 historical capitals of France.

Weight *

5

point(s)

Relative significance to the overall rubric

Criteria Type

Instruction Following

What does this Criterion judge? Pro Tip:
Utilized the Guidelines in the upper right hand
corner of your screen for a more detailed
breakdown of these options.

Objective/Subjective

Objective

Would most people agree on whether this
criterion is met (objective) or could there be
reasonable argument based on personal
opinion/taste (subjective).

Explicit/Implicit

Explicit

Does this Criterion assess something directly
requested by the Prompt (explicit) or is this
inferred by the "spirit" of the prompt (implicit)?

Add **Weight** to each Criterion to indicate the level of importance:

5 (Crucial)

- Must have this to answer the question properly
- Obviously needed based on what was asked
- A good answer can't ignore this

Step 2: Create A Rubric

3 (Important)

- Makes the answer much better
- Expected or implied by the question
- You could still give a decent answer without it if everything else is covered

1 (Less Important)

- Nice extra touch that might make the answer even better
- Could help one answer beat another
- The answer can still be good without this

Note: You wouldn't want the only difference between answers to be just one of these minor points

Indicate **Criteria Type**:

Criteria Type	Definition
Instruction Following	• Did the response do what was asked? • Followed the rules and requirements given • Completed the specific task requested
Truthfulness	• Is the information accurate and correct? • Based on real facts and evidence • Uses logical reasoning
Writing Style / Presentation	• Easy to read and understand • Good tone and structure • Clear and well-organized • Not too long or too short
Other	• Other criteria not captured by the above categories.

Identify if the criterion is **Objective** or **Subjective**:

	Definition
Objective	Almost all reviewers would agree on the factuality of the information

Step 2: Create A Rubric

Subjective

The evaluation of the criteria is not based on an objective fact but rather a feeling, emotion, or general sense. This is not about whether you believe the criteria should be included but rather about whether the criteria can be evaluated consistently across large groups of people.

Identify if the criterion is **Explicit** or **Implicit**:

	Definition	Example Prompt	Example Criterion
Explicit	criteria directly stated in the prompt.		The response identifies the y-intercept as (0,5).
Implicit	criteria inferred from/implied by the prompt and the user's intention.	Identify the y-intercept on the attached graph.	The response shows that the y-intercept is calculated by taking the equation of the line and setting $x=0$.

- 2c** Review all of the criteria and the rubric as a whole. When you've written out all the criteria, you should have a rubric that meets the following requirements:
- **Comprehensive** (no missing criteria- accounts for all aspects of the prompt including things that should not be included in a response)
 - **Relevant** (no unnecessary criteria)
 - **Accurate** (criterion that are objective and correct)
 - **Provides the blue prints for a "Golden Response"**
 - **Accounts for deviations amongst responses**

Step 3: Evaluate Responses Against Rubric

Rate each response according to your rubric criteria. If you consider other dimensions, add them to your rubric!

Step 3: Evaluate Responses Against Rubric

How well did the models address each Rubric Criteria?

Response A

Response B

France has had several cities that served as its capital at different points in history. Here are the primary ones:

1. **Paris:** Paris has been the capital of France for the majority of its history. It was established as the capital in the late 10th century and has remained so, with a few exceptions.
2. **Versailles:** Although not officially the capital, Versailles served as the de facto political center during the reign of Louis XIV from 1682 to 1789. The royal court and government were based at the Palace of Versailles.
3. **Vichy:** Vichy was the seat of the government during World War II from 1940 to 1944. Officially, the government was referred to as Vichy France, named after the city where the government was based during the German occupation.
4. **Bordeaux:** Bordeaux briefly served as the capital during the Franco-Prussian War in 1870-1871 when Paris was under siege.

These shifts reflected political and historical circumstances, but Paris has remained the consistent and widely recognized capital of France throughout history.

0/1 completed

✓ The response must indicate 9 historical capitals of France.

Does this response meet this criterion?

☐ Fully meets criterion

☐ Partially meets criterion

☐ Does not meet criterion

Next

4a Rate each response according to your rubric criteria to Yes, Partially or No Issues.

Note: **"Partially"** is a rating that should be used sparingly, if at all. If you are giving out a lot of "Partially" ratings, consider breaking the criteria down into smaller parts!

4b Check the results of the response-criteria diagram to quickly review your ratings for each response and their performance on the criteria. This is a good opportunity to check the alignment of your ratings, rankings and rubric scores before moving on.

Step 3: Evaluate Responses Against Rubric

Here Are The Results Of Your Analysis

Criterion 1
The response must indicate 9 historical capitals of France.

Response A
Over the long sweep of French history, "capital" can be a tricky...

Does not meet criterion

Response B
France has had several cities that served as its capital at different...

Partially meets criterion

Step 4: Select Best Response

- 1 Review each of the responses side by side one more time. Based on your rubric evaluation, decide which response is better (and to which degree).

Step 4: Select Best Response

Be sure to answer based on your Rubric!

Response A	Response B
France has had several cities that served as its capital at different points in history. Here are the primary ones: 1. Paris: Paris has been the capital of France for the majority of its history. It was established as the capital in the late 10th century and has remained so, with a few exceptions. 2. Versailles: Although not officially the capital, Versailles served as the de	Over the long sweep of French history, "capital" can be a tricky concept—especially before early-modern times, when monarchs often moved their courts from city to city. Still, there are a few places generally recognized as having served as the seat of French royal or national government at one time or another. The most important include: 1. Tournai (5th century). • In the late 5th century, Childeric I and his son Clovis I (the first

Note: In the case of a tie, choose the side of your favorite response. (Think about why this response was your favorite, it may be a Rubric Criteria you should go back and add). If both responses are identical, choose the side of any response.

A is much better B is much better

☐ A ☐ A ☐ ☐ ☐ B ☐ B

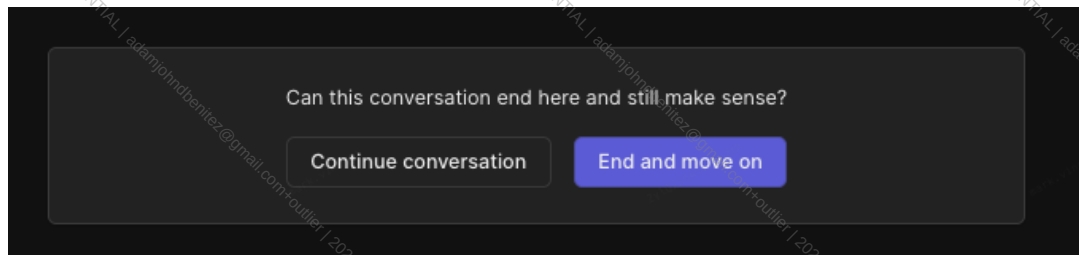
Note: If you feel that each response was perfectly tied, choose the response that you simply like more (this can be for any reason); then, return to your Rubric and add any criteria that explain this preference!

It is VERY IMPORTANT that your ratings align with your rankings

Step 5: Continue the Conversation (OPTIONAL)

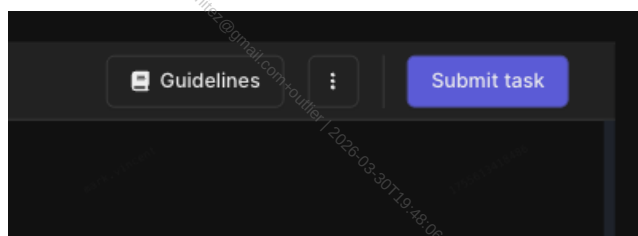
- 1 Many projects will ask you to provide follow up Prompts based on the previous question you've asked. This more closely replicates how people interact with AI models in the real world. While follow up is not required in this project, you are free to continue the conversation for one more "Turn" (Prompt-Response-Rating) to continue exploring!

Step 5: Continue the Conversation (OPTIONAL)



Step 6: Submit your Task!

- 1 Once you have either Ended or Completed the conversation, submit your task by selecting **Submit Task** on the upper right of your screen.



Appendix

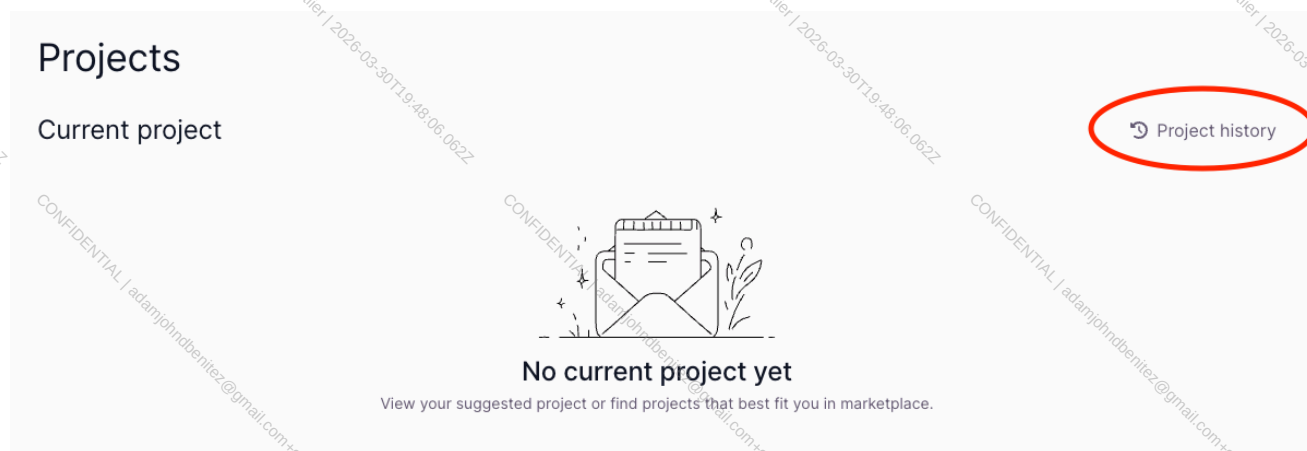
Next Steps

How to Find This Project in the Future

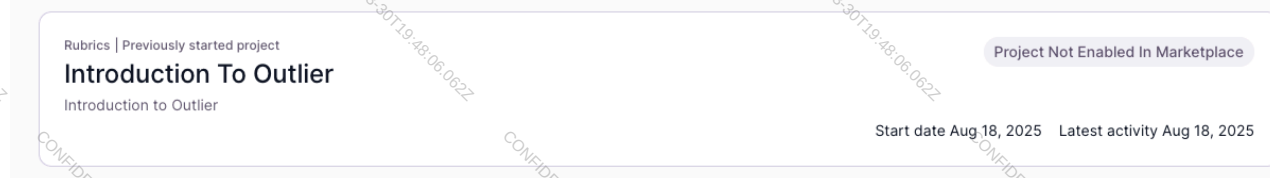
- 1 Navigate to your [Outlier Dashboard](#) and select the **Projects** tab at the top of your screen



- 2 Select **Project History**.



- 3 Locate and select **Introduction to Outlier** from your Project History list.



- 4 You can then use the tabs on the left to return to the related course or complete another test task.

How to Find This Project in the Future

Rubrics

Introduction To Outlier

Introduction to Outlier

Courses

Practice Tasks

History

Courses

Outlier Task Types: Rubrics

Rubrics Tasks are a fun, interesting, and cutting edge way to train AI Agents. This short video will get you started. Afterwards you will be able to use what you've learned in a practice task! →

Practice tasks

Instructive practice task

[View task →](#)

History

[Get back to the top](#) ↑